

Lesson 3

Writing Requests and Apologies



Warm-Up

Motivation Questions:

- Why is it important to write clear and polite requests in a business setting?
- Can you think of a situation where a well-written apology made a difference in a business relationship?
- How do you ensure your requests and apologies are understood and accepted by the recipient?





Sample Request and Apology Emails

Study the following sample emails

Subject: Request for Information

Dear John,

I hope this message finds you well. I am writing to request information regarding the upcoming project deadlines. Could you please provide the updated timeline at your earliest convenience?

Thank you for your assistance.

Best regards,

Anne Smith

Subject: Apology for Missed Deadline

Dear Anne,

I am writing to sincerely apologize for missing the project deadline. Due to unforeseen circumstances, we were unable to complete the task on time. We understand the inconvenience this has caused and are taking steps to ensure it does not happen again.

Thank you for your understanding.

Best regards,

John Dee

Analysis Questions:

- What elements make these emails clear and effective?
- How does the structure help the recipient understand the purpose of the email?
- What could be added to ensure all necessary information is included?

Discussion

- What are some common mistakes to avoid when writing requests and apologies?
- How can you make sure your request is polite yet assertive?
- What are some strategies to ensure your apology is sincere and accepted?



Common Phrases

KEY PHRASES FOR WRITING REQUESTS

Contents	Phrases
Opening Statements	• <i>"I hope this email finds you well."</i> • <i>"I am writing to request your assistance with..."</i> • <i>"I would like to ask for your help regarding..."</i>
Making the Request	• <i>"Could you please...?"</i> • <i>"Would it be possible for you to...?"</i> • <i>"I would appreciate it if you could..."</i>
Providing Context	• <i>"This request is important because..."</i> • <i>"Due to the upcoming deadline..."</i> • <i>"I would like to ensure that... by [specific date]."</i>
Closing Statements	• <i>"Thank you for considering my request."</i> • <i>"Please let me know if you need any further information."</i> • <i>"I look forward to your response."</i>

KEY PHRASES FOR WRITING APOLOGY EMAILS

Contents	Phrases
Opening Statements	• <i>"I hope this email finds you well."</i> • <i>"I am writing to sincerely apologize for..."</i>
Acknowledging the Issue	• <i>"I apologize for any inconvenience this may have caused."</i> • <i>"I acknowledge that this situation may have affected you."</i>
Taking Responsibility	• <i>"Full responsibility for the situation has been acknowledged."</i> • <i>"I am committed to making things right and learning from this experience."</i>
Offering an Explanation (if appropriate)	• <i>"The reason for this was..."</i> • <i>"Unfortunately, this occurred due to..."</i>
Proposing a Solution	• <i>"To rectify this situation, I will..."</i> • <i>"I am taking steps to ensure this does not happen again by..."</i> • <i>"I would like to offer [compensation or solution]."</i>
Closing Statements	• <i>"Thank you for your understanding and patience."</i> • <i>"Please let me know if there's anything else I can do to resolve this matter."</i>



Stressed Syllables

Practice pronouncing the following words.

- **Request** /rɪ'kwɛst/
- **Apology** /ə'pɒlədʒi/
- **Circumstances** /ˈsɜrkəmˌstænsɪz/
- **Inconvenience** /ˌɪnkənˈvinjəns/
- **Acknowledge** /əkˈnɒl.ɪdʒ/
- **Rectify** /ˈrɛk.tɪ.faɪ/



Practice

Instructions: Fill in the blanks with the correct polite words or phrases.

Making an Apology

Subject: _____ for the Delay

Hi Anna,

I'm really _____ for the delay in sending the file.
I had a technical problem, but I will send it today.

Thank you for your _____.

Kind regards,
Leo

Word Bank: *Sorry, Apology, Understanding*

Making a Request

Subject: _____ the Sales Report

Hi Sarah,

I hope you're well.

_____ you please send me the sales report for last month?

I need it by _____.

_____ in advance!

Best regards,

Tom

Word Bank: Could, Thank you, Monday, Request For



Production

WRITING EFFECTIVE REQUESTS AND APOLOGY

Instructions:

1. Scenario Assignment: Receive a scenario

Request	Apology
A. Requesting a meeting with a colleague.	A. Apologizing for a missed deadline.
B. Asking for additional resources for a project.	B. Apologizing for a scheduling conflict.
C. Requesting feedback on a recent presentation.	C. Apologizing for a delay in response to an email.
D. Asking a team member for assistance on a task.	D. Apologizing for missing a team meeting.
E. Requesting time off for a personal matter.	E. Apologizing for providing incorrect information in a previous communication.

2. Writing Emails: Write an email based on your scenario, including:

Request	Apology
• Greeting: Polite salutation • Purpose: Clear statement of the request • Details: Specific information needed • Politeness: Courteous language • Closing: Professional sign-off	• Greeting: Polite salutation • Acknowledgment: Recognition of the issue • Responsibility: Taking responsibility for the mistake • Remedy: Offering a solution or remedy • Closing: Professional sign-off

3. Exchange Requests: Swap your emails with a partner and use feedback forms to assess clarity and politeness.

4. Feedback Review: Review your partner's request and provide feedback on:

- **Clarity:** Is the request easy to understand?
- **Politeness:** Is the tone courteous and professional?
- **Specificity:** Are the details of the request clear and specific?

5. Discussion: Share experiences and insights with the group, focusing on strengths and improvements.